

Excel Formula Cheat Sheet

Frequently forgotten formulas and patterns for everyday business work

Practical Tools & Guides | Built for real-world reference, learning, and repeatable work.

Tip

Exact function availability can vary by Excel version. XLOOKUP, FILTER, UNIQUE, SORT, LET, and other dynamic-array functions require modern Excel versions.

1. Basic math and totals

Need	Formula
Sum	=SUM(B2:B100)
Average	=AVERAGE(B2:B100)
Minimum	=MIN(B2:B100)
Maximum	=MAX(B2:B100)
Count numbers	=COUNT(B2:B100)
Count nonblank	=COUNTA(B2:B100)
Round to 2 decimals	=ROUND(B2,2)

2. Conditional formulas

=IF(B2>=90,"Excellent",IF(B2>=75,"Meets","Needs Review"))
=IFS(B2>=90,"Excellent",B2>=75,"Meets",TRUE,"Needs Review")
=IFERROR(A2/B2,0)

3. COUNTIF / SUMIF

=COUNTIF(C:C,"Active")
=COUNTIFS(C:C,"Active",D:D,"Medford")
=SUMIF(A:A,"Travel",B:B)
=SUMIFS(D:D,A:A,"Finance",B:B,">="&DATE(2026,1,1))

4. Lookups

=XLOOKUP(A2,Customers[CustomerID],Customers[CustomerName],"Not Found")
=VLOOKUP(A2,\$H\$2:\$J\$100,3,FALSE)

=INDEX(J:J,MATCH(A2,H:H,0))

5. Text cleanup

Need	Formula
Trim extra spaces	=TRIM(A2)
Remove nonprinting characters	=CLEAN(A2)
Uppercase	=UPPER(A2)
Lowercase	=LOWER(A2)
Proper case	=PROPER(A2)
Left characters	=LEFT(A2,5)
Right characters	=RIGHT(A2,4)
Length	=LEN(A2)
Combine text	=TEXTJOIN(" ",TRUE,A2:C2)

6. Splitting and extracting text

=TEXTBEFORE(A2,"-")

=TEXTAFTER(A2,"-")

=TEXTSPLIT(A2,",")

7. Dates

Need	Formula
Today	=TODAY()
Current date/time	=NOW()
Year	=YEAR(A2)
Month number	=MONTH(A2)
Month name	=TEXT(A2,"mmmm")
Days between	=B2-A2
Months between	=DATEDIF(A2,B2,"m")
Years between	=DATEDIF(A2,B2,"y")
End of month	=EOMONTH(A2,0)
Add months	=EDATE(A2,3)

8. Dynamic arrays

=UNIQUE(A2:A1000)

=SORT(A2:D100,2,1)

=FILTER(A2:D100,D2:D100="Active","No matches")

9. Useful checks

=COUNTBLANK(A2:A100)

=COUNTIF(A2:A100,A2)>1

=ISBLANK(A2)

=ISNUMBER(A2)

=ISTEXT(A2)

10. Percentage change

=(C2-B2)/B2

11. Absolute and mixed references

Reference	Meaning
A1	Row and column both move when copied.
\$A\$1	Row and column both locked.
\$A1	Column locked, row moves.
A\$1	Row locked, column moves.

12. Common error messages

- #N/A: a lookup did not find a match.
- #VALUE!: incompatible data type or argument.
- #DIV/0!: division by zero or blank denominator.
- #REF!: formula points to a deleted or invalid reference.
- #SPILL!: a dynamic array cannot expand because cells are blocked.
- Numbers stored as text: inspect formatting, apostrophes, spaces, or use VALUE().

13. When to use something else

- Use Excel for quick analysis, business-friendly review, smaller datasets, and ad hoc models.
- Use Power Query when repeatable file cleanup or reshaping is the main task.
- Use SQL when relationships, validation, repeatable joins, and structured datasets matter.
- Use Power BI or Tableau when the goal is interactive reporting and visualization.